

Limits of own Authority

- **Scope of Practice:** Only performing treatments for which you are qualified and competent. A Level 3 Facial will enable you to provide a facial treatment, neck and shoulder massage and the main facial electrical treatments. It does not automatically qualify you for Level 4 aesthetic procedures such as skin needling, laser, or chemical peels, which require further training.
- **Health and Safety:** While responsible for monitoring and maintaining health and safety, you cannot override statutory or salon-specific health and safety instructions. Their authority is to follow and enforce established procedures, not create or significantly alter them.
- **Medical Diagnosis and Claims:** Facial practitioners cannot diagnose medical conditions, prescribe medication, or claim to "heal or cure a condition". You can only advise on skincare and beauty regimes and must refer clients with complex or contra-indicated conditions to appropriate healthcare professionals.
- **Client Age Restrictions:** Strict legal limitations apply to treating minors. In England, for example, it is illegal to provide botulinum toxin or dermal fillers to anyone under the age of 18. For other treatments, a facial practitioner must not treat a child (under 16) without prior written parental/guardian consent and their presence during the treatment. Ethics and morals must also be considered. Does the minor need the treatment? Do they have realistic expectations, which ingredients/equipment would be safe to use?
- **Confidentiality and Data Protection:** Facial practitioners have a professional responsibility to maintain client confidentiality and comply with data protection laws (like the GDPR). You cannot share client information with other professionals without the client's written consent, except in specific, legally mandated circumstances.
- **Working with Colleagues:** An essential part of professional standards is understanding their role within a team structure, which includes being aware of the responsibilities and limitations of other team members. This awareness ensures effective team working and professional boundaries are respected.
- **Environmental Control:** Facial practitioners are expected to ensure the environmental conditions (temperature, lighting, sound) are suitable for the client and service, and to follow workplace instructions for safe use and disposal of waste.

In essence, a Level 3 facial practitioner operates as a highly skilled practitioner within established guidelines and procedures, using their judgment to ensure client safety and professional standards, but is limited by their specific training and legal/ethical regulations.